

RVASec 2026

Community is a Control: Strengthening Cybersecurity Through Connection

Chelsea Bryan
Security Operations Analyst



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Agenda

- whoami
- Help
- Teams
- Build
- Community
- ???
- Questions



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WE ARE THE UNCOMMON.

After this talk..

Have connections, motivation,
and a stronger belief in
yourself.



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whoami

- 4 years SOC Analyst for VCU, IR/threat monitoring and security awareness programing.
- Special interest in mental health + human dynamics in security.
- A cat person.
- My own mess of imposter syndrome.



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WE ARE THE UNCOMMON.

Have you ever felt afraid to ask for help?



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You can't do it all alone.



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We need people, we need a team.



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What makes a team?

- A boss. Staff list. Paycheck.



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What makes a team?

- Trust. Communication.
Respect. Shared Purpose.

Check your ego at the door

- Every member of the team brings value.
- Technology evolves, you can't know everything.
- Identify the value you bring and learn to back yourself.
- Every human has flaws.

Check your ego at the door

- You can buy all the tools your want.
- Implement all the LLMs.
- But you are always going to need a community of people to manage, guide, and escalate when things go wrong.



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Community?
What does community look like?



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RVASEC **15**
2026

**GET YOUR
TICKET TODAY**

JUNE 9–10, 2026 | RICHMOND, VA

R V A S E C . C O M



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Community

- Community is what makes us strong, you being here today shows the importance of community in Cyber Security.

Community Means

- Building relationships outside your own team.
- Finding a second home within your organization.
- Being transparent about your needs.



When you feel like you don't belong

- Confidence isn't knowing everything.
- It's knowing you're not alone.



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How many of you have had to work
after hours responding to an incident
or to fix something that broke?





Build Community Before You Need It

- Share knowledge
- Check in after incidents
- Mentor others
- Join your broader security community



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OPEN CRAFT NIGHT

EVERY THIRD WEDNESDAY

Meeting - June



Hosted by **Jake K. and Chris S.**



Jake K. is a **Super Organizer**

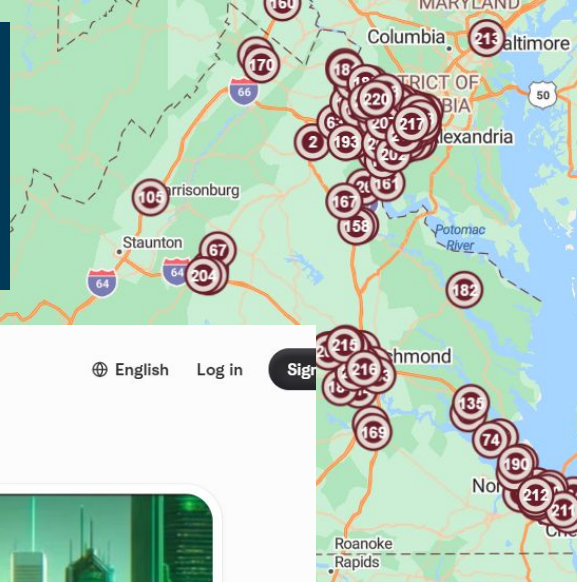


RVAssec Security Community >

4.8 ★★★★★ 151 reviews

Details

RVAssec Monthly is Richmond's unparalleled networking event for security professionals and anyone looking to break into the industry. Come by our relaxed meetings and socialize with others in the industry and have a beverage.



English

Log in

Sign



Wednesday, Jun 17 · 5:00 PM to 8:00 PM EDT



Needs a location

COMMON.

How do I create it?!



Chelsea Bryan • You
Security Operations Analyst | GSEC | MBA
2w •

Calling all RVA Women in Cyber! Most of us are familiar with WiCyS. Today I created a WiCyS Richmond VA interest group! DM me or Join the Discord <https://lnkd.in/e9mm458q> lets grow #RVA #womenincybersecurity



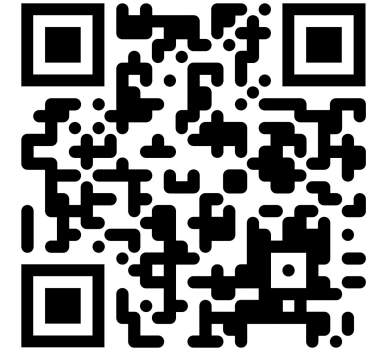
Members (3+)



ADVANCING

Women in CyberSecurity

A community of women, men, allies, and advocates that support the WiCyS mission to **recruit, retain and advance women in cybersecurity** as part of a *workforce solution*.



RVAWomenInCyber Discord



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WE ARE THE UNCOMMON.

Community

- Human beings NEED community.

Community

- YOU have the power to create connections!

One person can detect a threat.
A community can predict, prevent,
and recover from it.



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Questions?



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Don't be afraid to ask for help.

Call or text 988, Available 24hrs.
(mental health hotline)

Open up to friends or family.

Not everyone understands, but
someone out there does.

Don't give up.



Thank You!

My LinkedIn



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